

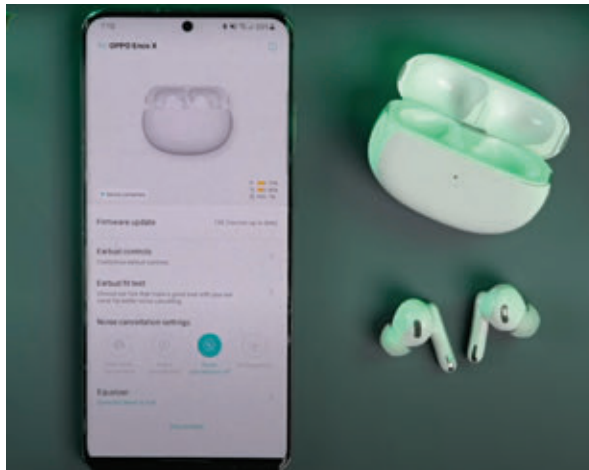
not come with Multipoint in their truest form, but they allow quick-switch, which enables you to change devices in a blink.

Battery Life: Now, this is something that you will have to try before you buy. There are brands in this budget segment that make tall claims about battery life; however, there have been instances where the brands fail to live up to their claims. So, ensure that you read our reviews and other user reviews, or write to us, to get an idea of the the actual battery life of the earbuds.

Something that has made a recent entry into the budget TWS market is **Active Noise Cancellation**. There are a few offerings around the ₹3,000 mark, like the OnePlus Buds 2 and the Redmi Buds 5 that offer this feature. So, if you are working with ₹3,000 to ₹5,000 you should definitely have ANC on your list of features that you look at. Things like a good **IP rating** are nice to have, and you can expect earbuds to have an IP X5 or IP 65 rating when purchasing your TWs in-ear earphones in this price range. For gamers, **low latency mode** is a plus. From what I have seen in my experience with budget TWS earphones, the battery drains faster on budget TWS earphones faster than their expensive counterparts; however, most brands have managed to implement this feature fairly well.

WHAT SHOULD YOU EXPECT IN TERMS OF SOUND SIGNATURE?

There is enough data that we have gathered after years of testing TWS in-ear earphones that suggests that most TWS earbuds that are available under ₹5,000 tend to have a **bass-forward sound signature**. Now, the level of bass enhancement depends on the kind of tuning that the brand has done, but



you can stay assured that the bass in these earphones will be bloated. So, if you are a fan of genres like hip-hop, pop, and Bollywood music or call yourself a bass-head, then you will definitely not be disappointed by the earbuds in this price range.

MID-RANGE TWS (BETWEEN ₹5,000 AND ₹10,000)

When you come to TWS earbuds in this price range, the lines between the features offered by earbuds and premium earphones blur. Over here, you need to ensure how well the brand is implementing the features that they advertise on their offerings. If you are on the extreme end of this budget spectrum, then you will get close to flagship features, and if you are lucky, then during sales, you could get your hands on a pair of flagship earphones as well! The

sky is the limit, with tempered expectations of how you will reach it when talking about the features included in mid-range TWS in-ear earphones.

Let's look at some features that should be non-negotiable when you are purchasing mid-range TWS in-ear earphones –

Active Noise Cancellation: With mid-range TWS earphones, you will definitely find yourself some really well-performing ANC TWS earphones. There are often decibel values attached to the ANC efficacy of TWS earphones. However, depending on the scenarios that you are putting yourself in when using your earphones, your mileage will vary. Again, don't go by the stat sheets.

Wireless Charging: This is something that has tricked down from the premium category into the mid-range over time. Now, some offerings come with really high-speed wireless charging.

Battery Life: In terms of battery life, there are some earphones in this price range that champion battery life. You will find some marathon runners in this price range. But again, you will need to temper your usage to get the most juice out of the device that you are using.

In-app customisations: In-app customisations help you make your TWS earphones truly your own. The design and UX of the app, the level of customisations it offers, and whether or not, you get an EQ, should govern your judgement in this department. I would say, definitely look for customisable controls and EQ.

As for other features, you should definitely look at getting **Hi-Res CODECs** supported by your earbuds. LDAC and aptX are the two most popular high-resolution CODECs that you can get in this price range. Additionally, in-app features like **ear tip fit tests and sound profile personalisation** are things that you should definitely be on the lookout